

TrustMRR: Does Positioning Predict Revenue More Than Popularity?

An analysis of 1,000 startup listings — testing whether structural segment explains revenue better than popularity signals

Dataset source: TrustMRR marketplace · Data frozen · Sample size: $n=1,000$

BACKGROUND

What TrustMRR Is — and Why This Dataset

TrustMRR is a marketplace where founders list SaaS and digital businesses for sale, with self-reported or platform-verified revenue, subscriber, and traffic metrics. Because every listing carries a consistent revenue metric (MRR), the dataset is unusually well-suited for comparative analysis.

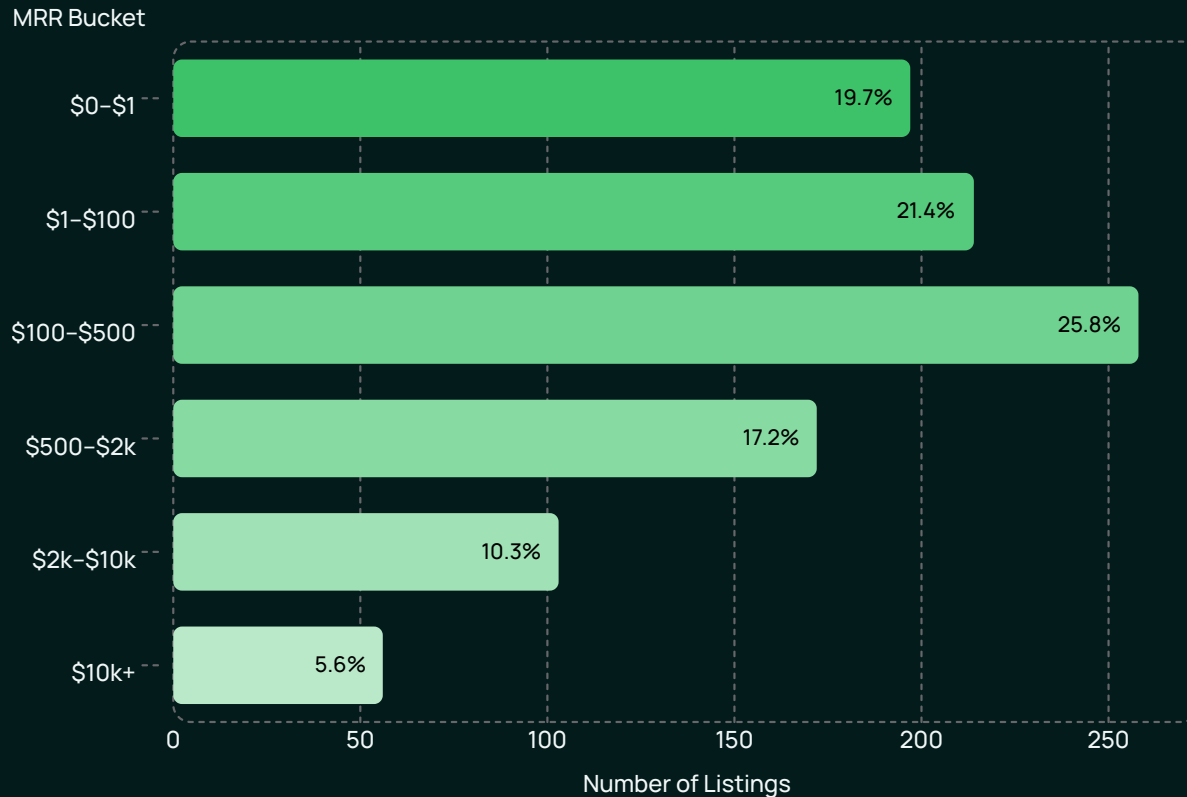
This dataset suits the hypothesis because it contains both **popularity fields** (X followers, domain rating, category size) and **structural fields** (audience type, category, country) alongside a consistent revenue metric, letting us compare which set of signals better separates high- and low-revenue businesses.

One caveat upfront: data completeness varies by field. Followers and domain rating are populated for ~70% of listings; category and country for ~73–76%. All downstream comparisons use only the rows with valid data for that specific test.

Field	% Populated
mrr_usd	100%
audience_type	~94%
category	~73%
country	~76%
domain_rating	~71%
x_followers	~71%

BASELINE

Revenue Distribution Across the Dataset



Revenue Is Highly Concentrated

Before testing any predictor, the baseline shows revenue is far from normally distributed.

\$13,472

Mean MRR

Pulled up by a small number of high-revenue listings

\$282

Median MRR

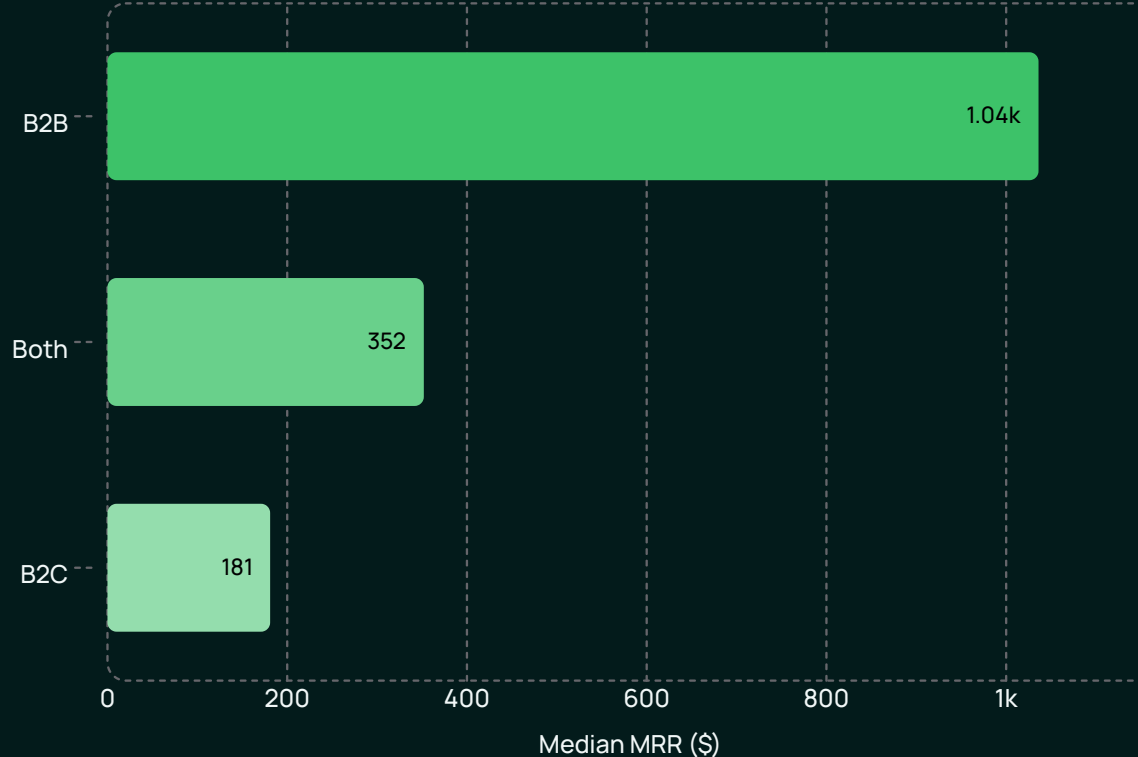
The typical listing earns far less than the mean

The **top 10 listings** account for **48%** of total MRR. The **top 50 listings** account for **71%**. Any variable we test has to explain this concentration — not just describe an average business.

Audience Type: B2B vs. B2C

The first structural variable tested — who a business sells to — shows the **largest effect size of any variable in the analysis**. B2B businesses post 5.7× the median revenue of B2C businesses.

Audience Type



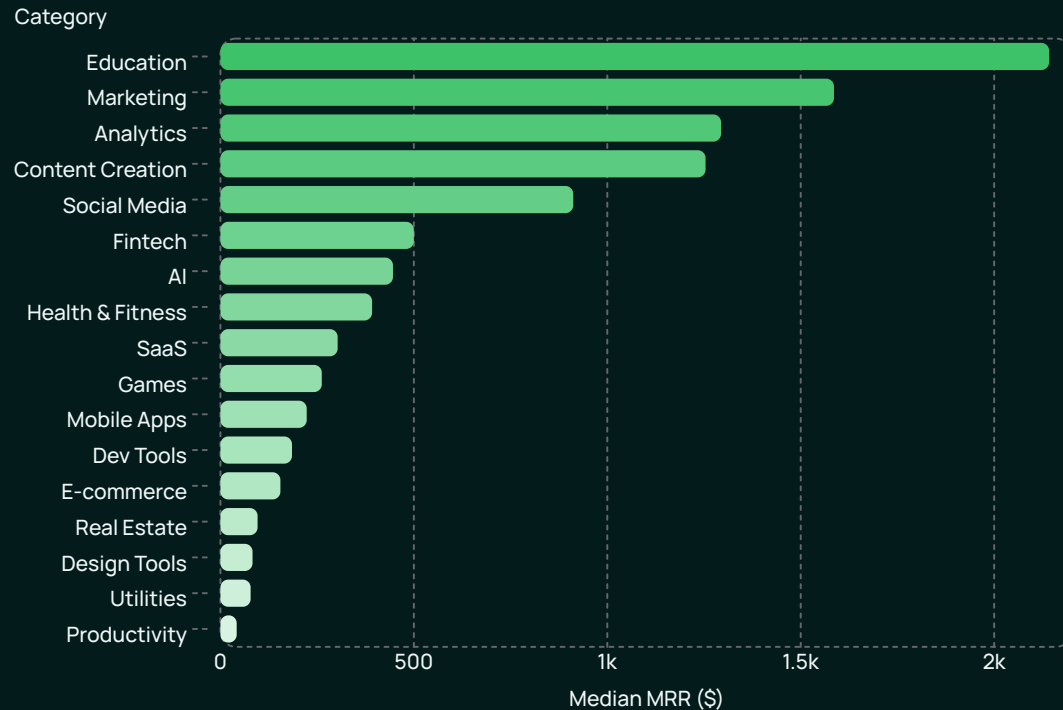
Median MRR by Audience Type

Audience Type	Median MRR	Count
B2B	\$1,036	255
Both	\$352	56
B2C	\$181	401

5.7× Gap

B2B median MRR vs. B2C median MRR — the largest effect size observed across all variables tested in this analysis.

Category: Revenue Varies Widely — but Category Size Doesn't Predict It

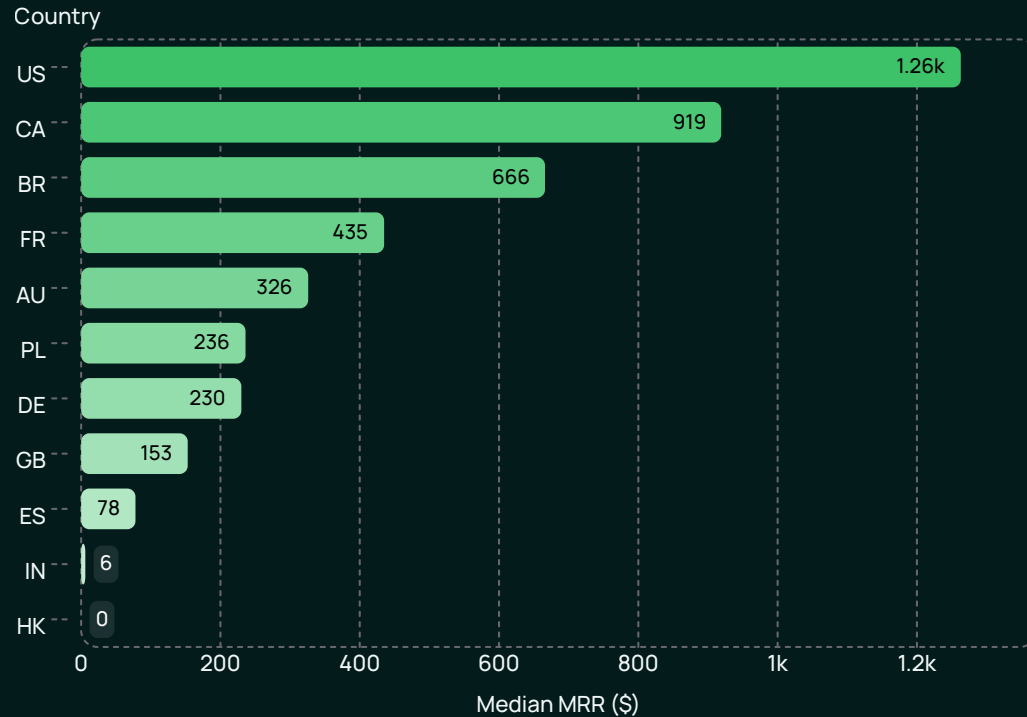


Categories with $n \geq 15$, sorted by Median MRR

Category	n	Median MRR
Education	30	\$2,142
Marketing	42	\$1,586
Analytics	19	\$1,294
Content Creation	36	\$1,254
Social Media	18	\$912
Fintech	16	\$500
AI	197	\$446
Health & Fitness	34	\$392
SaaS	66	\$303
Productivity	49	\$42

Category size does **not** predict category revenue: Spearman $\rho = 0.09$ between category count and category median MRR — effectively zero. AI ($n=197$, the largest category) posts only \$446 median MRR.

Geography: Real but Less Consistent Than Audience Type



Countries with $n \geq 15$, sorted by Median MRR

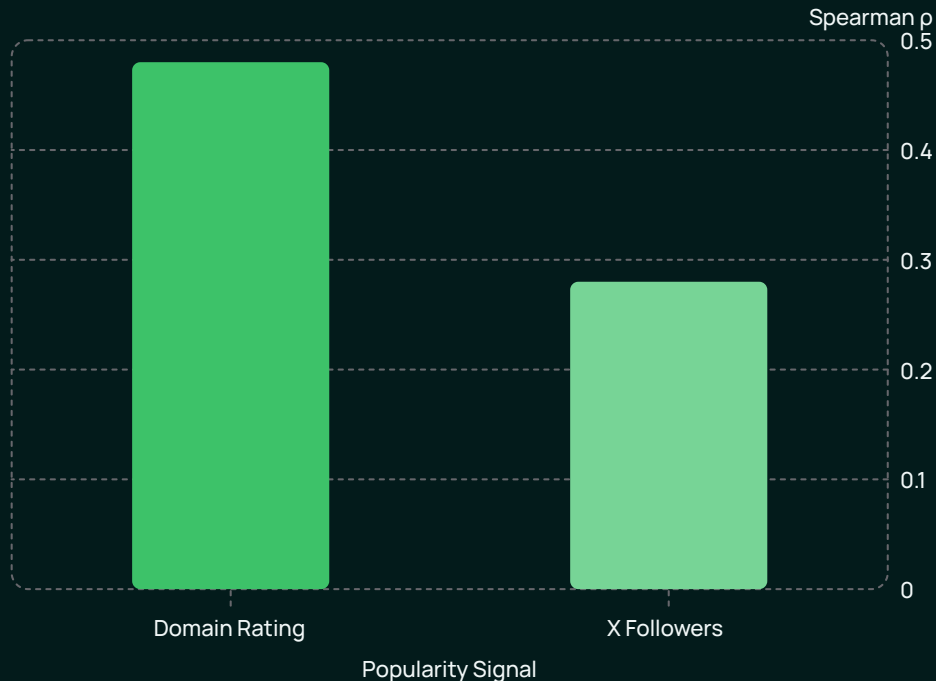
Country	n	Median MRR
US	258	\$1,263
CA	29	\$919
BR	20	\$666
FR	79	\$435
AU	17	\$326
DE	24	\$230
GB	50	\$153
ES	16	\$78
IN	59	\$6
HK	19	\$0

The gap between top and bottom is **over 200×**, though Poland, Spain, and Hong Kong have small enough samples that estimates are noisy. Notably, Canada and Brazil outperform India and the UK despite smaller counts.

Followers & Domain Rating vs. Revenue

Testing the "popularity" side of the hypothesis directly: does audience size (X followers) or site authority (domain rating) correlate with MRR? Based on $n=700$ listings with both fields populated.

Domain Rating vs. MRR



Correlation Summary ($n=700$)

Popularity Signal	Spearman ρ with MRR
Domain rating	0.48
X followers	0.28

Domain Rating

Moderate positive correlation ($\rho = 0.48$) – the strongest single popularity signal tested. A secondary but genuinely useful predictor.

X Followers

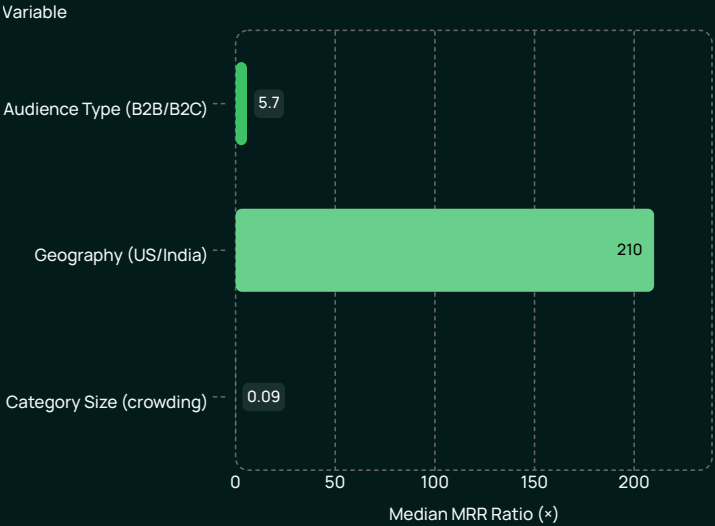
Weak positive correlation ($\rho = 0.28$). Pearson $r = 0.03$ – the relationship is non-linear and driven by a small number of outliers.

Neither popularity signal approaches the effect size seen for audience type (B2B vs. B2C).

Structural Segmentation vs. Popularity Signals

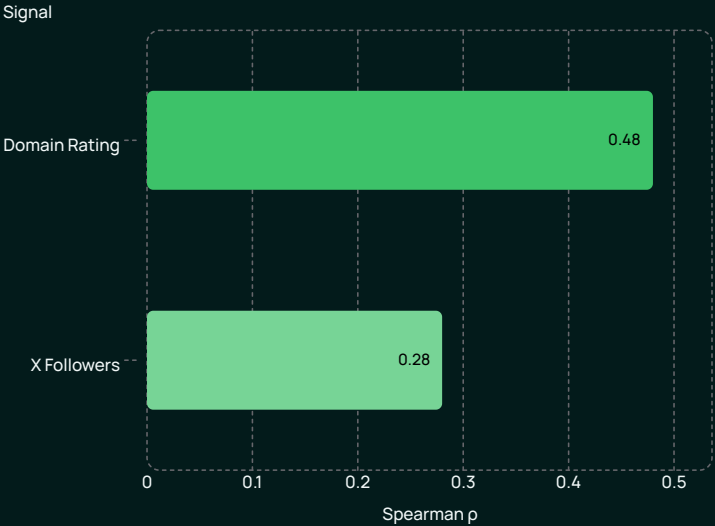
Direct comparison of effect sizes across all tested variables to answer the hypothesis. Two distinct scales are used below — median MRR ratios for structural variables, and Spearman ρ for popularity signals — to avoid implying false comparability between a ratio and a correlation coefficient.

Structural Variables — Median MRR Gap



Note: Geography ratio is large but includes small-sample countries (India $n=59$, HK $n=19$) — treat as directional.

Popularity Signals — Spearman ρ



Summary Table

Variable	Type	Effect
Audience type (B2B vs B2C)	Structural	5.7× median MRR gap
Domain rating	Popularity	$\rho = 0.48$
Geography (US vs IN)	Structural	~200× (small-sample caveat)
X followers	Popularity	$\rho = 0.28$
Category size (crowding)	Structural	$\rho = 0.09$ (no relationship)

CONCLUSION

Structural Positioning Wins

Direct answer to the hypothesis: structural positioning — specifically *who a business sells to* (B2B vs. B2C) — is the strongest predictor of revenue in this dataset, outperforming both popularity signals and category crowding.

Primary Finding

Audience type (B2B vs. B2C) is the single strongest variable: 5.7× median MRR gap. Check this first before any popularity metric.

Secondary Signal

Domain rating ($\rho = 0.48$) is a moderately useful secondary predictor. Follower count ($\rho = 0.28$) and category size ($\rho = 0.09$) are weak or negligible.

Caveats

Based on listings with complete data (~70–76%); country-level findings for small samples are directional only; this is a marketplace sample, not a random startup sample.

Practical implication: if using popularity metrics as a proxy for business quality, audience type is a more reliable — and much simpler — signal to check first.